

might be helpful to see how many MSS, or content segments, fall at the intersections of the two parameters:

	<u>I</u>	<u>II</u>	<u>III</u>	<u>IV</u>	<u>V</u>	<u>total</u>
E+++		1				1
E++	3					3
E+	5	2	1			8
E	6	5	2			13
E-		1	3			4
O-		1		2		3
E/M			1			1
M-		3	1			4
M			5			5
M+					5	5
M++			2		10	12
M+++					10	10
M++++					8	8
M+++++					1	1

0274 and 063 are fragmentary, which presumably accounts for their exceptional scores, E+++ and M+++++ respectively; if they were more complete they would probably each come down a level. Out of 45 M segments 31 score above 80%, while 9 are over 95% ‘pure’. It should be possible to reconstruct the greater part of a ‘Byzantine’ archetype with tolerable confidence. But one has to wonder how Aland arrived at the ‘Egyptian’ norm in the Gospels since the best Egyptian witness (except for the fragmentary 0274, which has less than 10% of the text but scores 90%), Codex B, barely passes 70%. (In *The Text*, p. 95, Aland gives a summary for P⁷⁵ in Luke—it scores 77%.) Further, besides B and 0274, P⁷⁵ and Z (both also fragmentary) are the only Greek MSS that score so much as an E+ in the Gospels. One is reminded of E.C. Colwell’s conclusion after attempting to reconstruct an ‘average’ or mean Alexandrian text for the first chapter of Mark. “These results show convincingly that any attempt to reconstruct an archetype of the Beta [Alexandrian] Text-type on a quantitative basis is doomed to failure. The text thus reconstructed is not reconstructed but constructed; it is an artificial entity that never existed.”¹

For the other content areas the situation is not much better. Only P⁷⁴ (86%), B (85%) and 81 (80%) rate an E++ in **a**; apart from them only A and Aleph manage even an E+. Codex B is the only E++ (80%) in **p**, and only P⁴⁶, A, C, 048 and 1739 manage an E+. Aside from B’s 88% in **c**, only P⁷⁴, A and 1739 manage even an E+. How did Aland arrive at his

¹ “The Significance of Grouping of New Testament Manuscripts”, *New Testament Studies*, IV (1957-1958), 86-87.